

Data Cleaning Report – Project 1

Project Title: Data Cleaning & Preparation

Intern Name: BHUMI BHATEJA

Organization: DecodeLabs

Tool Used: Microsoft Excel

1. Objective

The objective of this project was to clean and prepare the raw dataset for further analysis by identifying missing values, checking duplicate records, and correcting data formats. Proper data cleaning is an essential step in data analytics because it ensures that the dataset is accurate, consistent, and ready for meaningful analysis.

2. Cleaning Steps Performed

The following data cleaning steps were carried out on the dataset:

- Checked the **OrderID** column for duplicate values using the **COUNTIF** function.
 - Verified that all **OrderID** values were unique.
 - Used Excel's **Remove Duplicates** feature to check for duplicate rows in the dataset.
 - Reviewed important columns to identify missing or blank values.
 - Found blank values in the **CouponCode** column and replaced them with **"No Coupon"**.
 - Verified the **Date** column and converted it into a proper **DD-MM-YYYY** format.
 - Reviewed numeric columns such as **Quantity**, **UnitPrice**, **ItemsInCart**, and **TotalPrice** to ensure they were stored in the correct format.
 - Confirmed overall data consistency after cleaning.
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3. Issues Found in the Dataset

During the data cleaning process, the following issues were identified:

- Blank values were present in the **CouponCode** column.
 - The **Date** column required standardization into a consistent format.
 - No duplicate **OrderID** values were found.
 - No duplicate rows were found in the dataset.
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4. Fixes Applied

To resolve the issues identified in the dataset, the following corrections were made:

- Blank cells in the **CouponCode** column were replaced with **"No Coupon"**.
 - The **Date** column was standardized into **DD-MM-YYYY** format.
 - The dataset was checked thoroughly for duplicate **OrderID** values and duplicate rows.
 - Numeric columns were verified to ensure proper formatting and consistency.
 - The final dataset was reviewed to confirm that it was clean and analysis-ready.
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5. Final Result

The dataset was successfully cleaned and prepared for analysis. Duplicate **OrderID** values were checked and verified, duplicate rows were reviewed, missing values were handled, and date formatting was standardized. As a result, the final dataset is accurate, consistent, and ready for the next stage of data analysis.

6. Conclusion

This project helped in understanding the importance of data cleaning in the analytics process. By handling missing values, verifying duplicates, and correcting formats, the dataset became more reliable and suitable for further analysis. This step is essential because clean data forms the foundation for accurate insights, reporting, and decision-making.